

The Self-Taught EMBA

Eight ten-week blocks, each pairing one *analytical* module with one *judgment* module — the way real programmes run them, because the numbers and the argument are learned against each other. Tick the work as you finish it; progress follows you between devices.

MODULES	BLOCKS	DURATION	CONTACT HOURS	WEEKLY LOAD	WRITTEN WORK
15	8	78 weeks	624	8 hrs	15 memos

CASES, NOT CHAPTERS

The learning is in the argument. Harvard Business Publishing, Ivey and Darden sell single cases to individuals for roughly \$9–11. Write your two-page recommendation **before** you read the teaching note.

IF YOU ONLY DO FOUR

ACC 501, FIN 521, STR 531, NEG 561. Those four carry most of what an EMBA actually changes about how you work. The rest deepens; these four convert.

YOUR OWN P&L IS THE COHORT

An EMBA's real value is fifty classmates arguing from fifty balance sheets. Alone, substitute **your employer**: value it, model its unit economics, run every framework against it.

SOURCING THE MATERIALS

Prior editions of the textbooks cost a fraction of current ones and differ trivially — buy used. Damodaran publishes his full NYU valuation course, slides and spreadsheets free at pages.stern.nyu.edu/~adamodar. Filings come free from EDGAR.

THE PART YOU CANNOT BUY

You can replicate the curriculum, not the room. Compensate deliberately: find three people who will read your memos and argue back, and present the capstone to them out loud. A recommendation nobody has attacked has not been tested.

ACC 501

Weeks 1–10
Hours 40

Financial Accounting

EXIT STANDARD

Read a 10-K without the summary, and trace a dollar of revenue through all three statements.

TEXTS

Ittelson, *Financial Statements* → Fridson & Alvarez, *Financial Statement Analysis*, ch. 1–8

CASE

Your employer's — or its closest competitor's — latest annual report, read cover to cover, footnotes included.

- ☐ Build three statements for a small business from raw transactions, by hand
- ☐ Trace an inventory change from the balance sheet through to cash flow
- ☐ Read one complete 10-K, including the notes and MD&A
- ☐ Write a two-page quality-of-earnings note on that filing

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DEC 511

Weeks 1–10
Hours 40

Statistics for Decision Making

EXIT STANDARD

Separate a real effect from noise, and know what a regression coefficient does not license you to claim.

TEXTS

Wheelan, *Naked Statistics* → Sharpe & De Veaux, *Business Statistics*, ch. 1–18

PRACTICUM

One regression built in a spreadsheet on data from your own function — not a textbook dataset.

- ☐ Sampling error and confidence intervals, worked until the arithmetic is automatic
- ☐ Run a multiple regression and inspect the residuals before believing it
- ☐ Design an A/B test and compute the sample size before it starts
- ☐ Write one finding up for an executive who will not read the method

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FIN 521

Weeks 11–20
Hours 40

Corporate Finance & Valuation

EXIT STANDARD

Value a company from its filings and defend the discount rate to someone who disagrees.

TEXTS

Damodaran, *Applied Corporate Finance*, alongside his free NYU MBA lecture series

PRACTICUM

A full discounted-cash-flow model of one listed company, built from primary filings.

- ☐ NPV, IRR and payback — twenty problems until the mechanics are reflex
- ☐ Estimate a WACC from market data rather than a textbook table
- ☐ Build a five-year DCF with an explicit, stated terminal-value assumption
- ☐ Stress it: identify the single assumption that moves value most

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ECO 505

Weeks 11–20
Hours 40

Managerial Economics

EXIT STANDARD

Anticipate how a rival responds before you move on price or capacity.

TEXTS

Dixit & Nalebuff, *The Art of Strategy* → Baye & Prince, *Managerial Economics*, ch. 1–11

PRACTICUM

One live competitive interaction in your industry, mapped as a game with payoffs.

- ☐ Estimate price elasticity for one product you actually sell
- ☐ Map where pricing power sits along your industry's value chain
- ☐ Solve the standard games: entry, capacity, price war, commitment
- ☐ Name one credible commitment your firm could make, and price it

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ACC 512

Weeks 21–30
Hours 40

Managerial & Cost Accounting

EXIT STANDARD

Know what a unit truly costs, and which costs a decision may legitimately ignore.

TEXTS

Horngren, *Cost Accounting*, ch. 1–14 → Goldratt, *The Goal*, for the intuition

PRACTICUM

A unit-economics model for one real product or service line, down to contribution margin.

- ☐ Separate fixed, variable and sunk — then kill one sunk-cost argument at work
- ☐ Build a contribution-margin model with a break-even volume
- ☐ Apply activity-based costing to a process you already know well
- ☐ Set a defensible transfer price between two internal units

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STR 531

Weeks 21–30
Hours 40

Competitive Strategy

EXIT STANDARD

State your firm's advantage in one sentence, and name what would destroy it.

TEXTS

Rumelt, *Good Strategy / Bad Strategy* → Porter, *Competitive Strategy*, ch. 1–7

CASE

One purchased case per week; memo written before the teaching note is opened.

- ☐ Five forces and a value-chain analysis of your own industry
- ☐ Distinguish business-unit strategy from corporate portfolio strategy
- ☐ Write a one-page strategy: diagnosis, guiding policy, coherent actions
- ☐ List the three developments that would invalidate it

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MKT 515

Weeks 31–40
Hours 40

Marketing Management

EXIT STANDARD

Price and position a product using numbers rather than adjectives.

TEXTS

Kotler & Keller, *Marketing Management* (skimmed for structure) → Farris et al., *Marketing Metrics*

PRACTICUM

A segmentation and lifetime-value model for a real customer base you can get data on.

- ☐ Segment a real customer base and size each segment in revenue
- ☐ Compute CAC, lifetime value and payback period for one channel
- ☐ Compare value-based, cost-plus and competitive pricing on one product
- ☐ Write a positioning statement and the evidence that supports it

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OPS 541

Weeks 31–40
Hours 40

Operations & Supply Chain

EXIT STANDARD

Find the bottleneck, and say what the inventory is actually buying you.

TEXTS

Cachon & Terwiesch, *Matching Supply with Demand* → Goldratt for the narrative version

PRACTICUM

A process map with measured cycle times for a workflow you personally own.

- ☐ Map a real process; compute capacity, utilisation and flow time
- ☐ Apply Little's Law to a queue in your own operation
- ☐ Set a stocking level under demand uncertainty (the newsvendor problem)
- ☐ Identify the bottleneck and cost out one hour of its downtime

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LED 551

Weeks 41–50
Hours 40

Leading Organizations

EXIT STANDARD

Diagnose why a group underperforms before you rearrange the org chart.

TEXTS

Edmondson, *The Fearless Organization* → Bolman & Deal, *Reframing Organizations*

PRACTICUM

A written diagnosis of one team you lead or belong to, shown to someone in it.

- ☐ Read one team through all four frames: structural, human, political, symbolic
- ☐ Design a role and its incentives, then predict how they will be gamed
- ☐ Run one real change initiative through an explicit eight-step plan
- ☐ Collect 360° feedback on yourself and write down what you will change

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NEG 561

Weeks 41–50
Hours 40

Negotiations

EXIT STANDARD

Arrive knowing your BATNA, their interests, and where value can be created rather than split.

TEXTS

Malhotra & Bazerman, *Negotiation Genius* → Fisher & Ury, *Getting to Yes*

PRACTICUM

Three real negotiations, each run from a written prep sheet and debriefed afterwards.

- ☐ Write a full prep sheet: BATNA, reservation price, ZOPA, their interests
- ☐ Practise value creation: multi-issue trades and contingent contracts
- ☐ Run three live negotiations and debrief each one in writing
- ☐ Meet one hard tactic — anchor, deadline, ultimatum — deliberately

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FIN 575

Weeks 51–60
Hours 40

M&A and Corporate Development

EXIT STANDARD

Say what a deal is worth to you — which is not what it is worth to the market.

TEXTS

Bruner, *Applied Mergers and Acquisitions* (selected chapters) → Rosenbaum & Pearl, *Investment Banking*

CASE

One recent transaction in your own sector, analysed end to end from public documents.

- ☐ Build a comparables and precedent-transactions valuation
- ☐ Model synergies separately from standalone value, and discount them harder
- ☐ Work the structure: cash versus stock, earn-outs, reps and warranties
- ☐ Write the first-hundred-days integration plan

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TEC 571

Weeks 51–60
Hours 40

Digital & Technology Strategy

EXIT STANDARD

Judge a technology investment on its economics rather than on the demo.

TEXTS

Parker, Van Alstyne & Choudary, *Platform Revolution* → Agrawal et al., *Prediction Machines*

PRACTICUM

A build-versus-buy-versus-partner recommendation for one real system in your organisation.

- ☐ Analyse one platform business: network effects, multi-homing, take rate
- ☐ Write the build/buy/partner recommendation with numbers attached
- ☐ Scope one AI use case: data required, baseline, expected lift, failure mode
- ☐ Name the technology risk most likely to obsolete your business model

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GOV 581

Weeks 61–70
Hours 40

Governance, Ethics & Enterprise Risk

EXIT STANDARD

Know what a board is for, and where the pressure to misbehave originates.

TEXTS

Bazerman & Tenbrunsel, *Blind Spots* → Larcker & Tayan, *Corporate Governance Matters*

CASE

Two documented corporate failures traced to root cause — the incentive, not the individual.

- ☐ Map your firm's governance: board, committees, delegated authorities
- ☐ Trace two real failures back to the incentive that produced them
- ☐ Build a risk register with likelihood, impact and a named owner per line
- ☐ Write the escalation path you would actually use under pressure

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GLB 585

Weeks 61–70
Hours 40

Global Markets & Country Risk

EXIT STANDARD

Put a defensible number on the risk of operating somewhere you do not control.

TEXTS

Ghemawat, *Redefining Global Strategy* (the CAGE framework) → Damodaran's country risk premium data

PRACTICUM

A market-entry analysis for one country your firm could plausibly enter next.

- ☐ Apply the CAGE distance framework to two candidate markets
- ☐ Quantify FX exposure across all three types: transaction, translation, economic
- ☐ Compare entry modes: export, licence, joint venture, wholly owned
- ☐ Price country risk into a discount rate and defend the number

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CAP 599

Weeks 71–78
Hours 64

Capstone: A Strategic Audit

EXIT STANDARD

Produce the document a board would actually read — and survive being questioned on it.

TEXTS

No new texts. Every framework from the preceding fourteen modules, applied to one company.

SUBJECT

One company you genuinely care about: your employer, a competitor, or an acquisition target.

- ☐ Industry and competitive analysis, every claim sourced
- ☐ Financial analysis and a valuation with a defended discount rate
- ☐ Operating diagnosis: where value leaks out, and why
- ☐ A recommendation with an implementation plan, a funding ask and its risks
- ☐ Present it aloud to three people who will argue with you

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